

SENATE RESOLUTION 40

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Kirk Whalum of Memphis.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts and artistic contributions, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Kirk Whalum of Memphis, an R&B and smooth jazz saxophonist and songwriter who has earned commercial success and critical acclaim during his four-decade career; and

WHEREAS, Kirk Whalum hails from the highly respected Whalum family of Memphis, the members of which, over four generations, have distinguished themselves time and again in the fields of music, worship, and public service; and

WHEREAS, twelve-time Grammy nominated Kirk Whalum is a member of the jazz group BWB, along with trumpeter Rick Braun and guitarist Norman Brown; he has worked and collaborated with such artists as Quincy Jones, Babyface, Michael McDonald, and Luther Vandross, to name but a few; and

WHEREAS, among his standout contributions are touring with Whitney Houston for more than seven years and soloing on her single "I Will Always Love You," the best-selling single by a female artist in music history, as well as winning his first Grammy in 2011 for Best Gospel Song with "It's What I Do," featuring Lalah Hathaway; and

WHEREAS, in addition to recording a series of well received solo albums and film soundtracks, he has also worked on a number of film scores, including those for *The Prince of Tides*, *Boyz n the Hood*, and *The Bodyguard*; and

WHEREAS, in June 2014, Mr. Whalum was the inaugural Jazz Legend honoree of the National Museum of African American Music in Nashville, and in September 2018, he received the coveted honor of a Brass Note on Historic Beale Street in Memphis; and

WHEREAS, throughout his many successes, he has enjoyed the love and support of his wife of forty-five years, Ruby, and their children, Kyle, Courtney, Kori, and Evan; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Whalum epitomizes the spirit and commitment to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we acknowledge and applaud Kirk Whalum for his commitment to excellence in music and beyond; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and commend Kirk Whalum for his lifetime of indelible contributions to music and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.